

Clermont County Township Association Meeting

Date: 11/21/2024

Host: Williamsburg Township

Meeting was called to order: 6:24 PM. Meeting called to order by Bob Hausermann. A prayer was offered by Bob McGee, and Tom Peck led the Pledge of Allegiance. Upon completion of the Pledge attendees proceeded to dinner.

Opening remarks: Approximately 6:53 PM, Bob Hauserman announced that a few guests that will be speaking this evening. Mr. Hausermann called upon LeeAnn Watson to take the floor and introduce herself.

Guest Speaker: Ms. Watson is the Executive Director of the Clermont County Mental Health & Recovery Board. Ms. Watson proceeded with her presentation discussing what the CC Mental Health & Recovery board is, and what services they provide for the County. At the end of Ms. Watson's presentation there was a brief Q&A with members. Ms. Watson concluded her presentation by reminding members that the Mental Health & Recovery Board welcomes to is open to coming to Townships to offer training including CIT team training for LE/Fire departments, among other services, and reminded members that they may like to share with their communities about the CCMHRB Crisis Hotline.

Mr. Hausermann then introduced a special guest speaker, Julia Hess, invited by Williamsburg Township to speak on the history of Williamsburg and early Clermont County. Guy Bainum then took the floor to give a more in-depth introduction of Ms. Hess and her service to their community.

Guest Speaker: Julia Hess proceeded with her wonderful and thorough presentation on the first 100 years of Williamsburg's history. At the conclusion of her presentation, Ms. Hess invited members with any detailed questions to approach her after the meeting. Additionally, she let members know that she had information sheets available on the Harmony Hill, and membership sign-up forms if anyone is interested.

Mr. Hausermann next moved toward the CCTA's business for the evening. He called upon Ms. Hinnners regarding a letter that she had prepared. Ms. Hinnners took the floor to discuss the request from the OTA asking the CCTA to write a letter to Senator Johnson for support for the SCIP which funds the OPWC. Senator Johnson had already cast a vote on the bill, which passed both chambers and was being sent to the Governor. Ms. Hinnners, because of the passage of the bill, has changed her letter requesting an affirmative vote, to a Thank You letter while still including that we would still ask that they increase the amount allocated to the Small Govt Fund by 10%. Discussion about the process for sending the letter, with Mr. Freeman reminding that in the past we have sent both hard-copy and e-mail letters for similar situations in the past. Discussion also about having Mr. Baird prepare a letterhead for the CCTA by using the logo/graphic from the CCTA website. Ms. Hinnners then reiterated that she felt it important to send the Thank You letter and shared the challenges that smaller townships face and how much they need this type of funding.

Discussion continued on how best for the CCTA to sign the letter. Should it be just signed CCTA, list all of the members' names, etc. Mr. Hausermann asked Mr. Freeman how this has been handled in the past. Mr. Freeman stated that in the past that the CCTA has just used the Chairman's signature and then usually including "on behalf of the Clermont County Township Association" along with the signature.

Ms. Hinnners then moved on to a discussion about House Bill 315, and inviting members to strongly sending letters in support of the passage of HB 315 and how important this bill will be for improving the function of Township government. A general discussion about some of the provisions of the potential changes and additions to the powers of Townships with regard to licensing and regulations for certain types of businesses beyond zoning restrictions, and how it can be beneficial for townships/revenue.

Discussion turned to another potential piece of the legislation: the new Community Authority Board, and what the potential impacts and benefits could be for township.

Ms. Hinnners then moved on to the proposed changes to the zoning violations and change the way they are handled. She feels it will be beneficial to help the process and improve community relations with regard to how long it takes to resolve violations... sometimes years.

Ms. Hinnners then asked if the CCTA needed a vote to approve the letter to Senator Johnson.

Mr. Hausermann made a motion to send the letter as it's written, seconded by Mr. Peck. Motion carried by majority, yea 13 nay 0.

Ms. Hinnners continued after the vote, moving on to updating on the One Ohio Region 14 Board. Just wants to bring the CCTA up to date as much as she can about the 150 grants that she had to review this summer. She has no notes, and is not permitted to speak about the details of the grant requests. She can share that all the regions have completed their grant review processes. And all those grants, once the regions approved, are now up in Columbus with the Foundation Board and the grant review committee is reviewing them, and are approximately 50% on the list. 3 of Region 14's grants have been approved, and one of those is in Clermont County. Can tell the CCTA that the one in Clermont County is a Peer Recovery Support Group, for approximately \$97K. Region 14 was one of the largest by amount of grants, and it was a big task to do the grant review process. She looks forward to 2025, and would like to say it should open up because she would like that and having the ability to call in another group meeting in Clermont County so she can tell people about how the grant review committee looked at it, this is what we liked and didn't like. In Region 14 there were 6 members on the grant committee review process, and she can say that the it's hard to look at things from a region view. Some had a very difficult time come out of their county and looking at it as a region when Region 14 has 7 counties. The Region 14 Board will meet again until February 2025.

Mr. Hausermann thanked Ms. Hinnners for her work and keeping the CCTA up to date with the OTA activities. Ms. Hinnners commented that in the future she anticipates that information sharing with the CCTA will happen much faster, and sending information to Mr. Bird, etc. Mr. Hausermann suggested that Ms. Hinnners comes up with some ideas for discussion at the January 2025 meeting.

Ms. Hinnners continued that she had one more idea that she wanted everyone to think about having to do with the CCTA talking about wanting to have a fundraiser. She reminded of the difficulties from the dinner fundraisers of the past with our baskets because only like half the county really have businesses to get donations, so it's hard for the rest of us to contribute. This is a longer-term project, but she suggests that we consider possibly doing a "tour of gardens". Because all of our townships have *something* that they would be able to contribute, and it would be more of a season long thing than just a one night event with a lot more people able to be involved in the process. This would take more of an event sign-up process, and open to a lot more hands in pot. It wouldn't just be the CCTA pounding on their business and would allow other townships to contribute to the process.

Mr. Hausermann thanked Ms. Hinnners for her updates and thoughts, and announced that the meeting would now move to the business of the association. Mr. Hausermann called upon Mr. Baird to present the Treasurer's reports.

Mr. Baird proceeded with the October 1st treasurer's report. Mr. Hausermann reiterated that the CCTA currently has 100% member participation among all elected township officials, so that is commendable as it is the first time that has happened in a while so he expressed thanks to everyone for making that happen. Mr. Hausermann then shared that he had given notes for minutes of the October 17th meeting so we won't be voting on any minutes this evening, and will catch up on those in January.

Mr. Hausermann then turned to the Shop with a Cop programs for 2024 as it is that time of year. We know that we have, in the past, made donations to four: Miami Township, Goshen Citizen's Police Academy, the Brewer Foundation at the Clermont County Sheriff's office, and Pierce Township Shop with a Cop program. Last year we gave each organization \$300. It seems like our balance is staying steady, that our membership dues seems to offset what we spend on the Shop with a Cop programs. Mr. Hausermann put forth the question to the association about being willing to donate to the Shop with a Cop programs again this year. Mr. Hausermann asked if there was any opposition to doing so.

Mr. Bainum made a motion to support the 4 Shop with a Cop programs stated by Mr. Hausermann. Seconded by another member. Mr. Hausermann called for a voice vote on the motion. All Aye with none opposed. Motion carried.

Mr. Hausermann continued with putting for the question of the amount for the donations. We have been giving \$300 a year, are we staying with \$300 or do we want to adjust the amount or adjust that number due to budget. Our budget is fine, we're status quo and funds appear to be stable as he has mentioned. Mr. Hausermann asked if we wanted to stay with that number, or do we want to modify that number somewhat.

Ms. Hinnners asked if we know how many kids, or toys this buys? Mr. Hausermann replied that he knows Goshen has 20 kids, and doesn't know many kids the other townships do but he does know that Goshen and Miami Townships used to share the Meijer on the same night in Miami Township and that Miami Township's roughly tripled Goshen's. He doesn't have a number, but he knows with certainty that it is significant. Ms. Hinnners continued with stating that \$300 is good for Goshen, but you're wondering if ... what does the Sheriff do, how do they do that? Mr. Hausermann replied that he really isn't sure, but

they have a Shop with a Cop program through the Brewer Foundation and when we went through last year's checkbook that is what we gave to them as well. Members commented that we should just keep it the same as last year.

Mr. Hausermann called for a motion to send \$300 each to the Shop with a Cop programs. Rick Hinson made the motion, seconded by Tom Peck. Mr. Hausermann called for a voice vote on the motion. All Aye with none opposed. Motion carried. Mr. Hausermann thanked the association members.

Mr. Hausermann then announced that we need to elect new officers for 2025. Mr. Hausermann opened up the elections by asking for a nomination for Secretary. Mr. Hausermann nominated Shelby Baird, and asked if any others had any nominations. Nomination seconded by Mr. Bainum. Mr. Hausermann called again for any other nominations for Secretary. None were given. Mr. Hausermann closed the nominations for Secretary and called for voice vote on the nomination of Mr. Baird. All Aye with none opposed. Mr. Hausermann thanked Mr. Baird.

Mr. Hausermann announced the next nomination would be for the OTA representative, identifying that the position was currently held by Ms. Hinnners. Mr. Peck nominated Ms. Hinnners, nomination was seconded by another member. Mr. Hausermann called again for any other nominations for OTA rep. None were given. Mr. Hausermann closed the nominations and called for a voice vote on the nomination of Ms. Hinnners. All Aye with none opposed. Mr. Hausermann thanked Ms. Hinnners.

Mr. Hausermann announced the next nominations will be for President and Vice-President. Mr. Hausermann called for nominations for President. Mr. Bainum nominated Mr. Hausermann, nomination was seconded by another member. Mr. Hausermann called again for any other nominations for President. Mr. Hausermann closed the nominations and called for voice vote on the nomination of Mr. Hausermann. All Aye with none opposed.

Mr. Hausermann called for nominations for Vice President. Mr. Hausermann nominated Mr. Freeman, seconded by Mr. Bainum. Mr. Hausermann called again for any other nominations for Vice President. Mr. Hausermann closed the nominations and called for a voice vote on the nomination of Mr. Freeman. All Aye with none opposed.

Mr. Hausermann called for nominations for the District 10 Representative. Mr. Hausermann stated that we have two names on that to fill. Mr. Bainum shared that two had been brought up, one was Mr. Peck and the second was Mr. Freeman. Mr. Hausermann asked for summary of District 10. Mr. Freeman shared that District 10 is basically the local part of the Ohio Public Works Commission, and OPWC recommends the road/bridge/sewer/water programs. There is an offshoot of that, which is the Natural Resource Advisory Council which Mr. Freeman has served on as the representative for Townships and his term is not yet expired. So the District 10 rep would be the other part of it, and Mr. Freeman has served as the alternate and Mr. Peck as the representative. Mr. Hausermann asked if we are nominating one or both. Mr. Freeman shared that in the past we have nominated both, so that that way ... since this is tallied and we are actually competing with other counties for the position, so the more votes we get the better. Mr. Freeman stated that in the past Mr. Peck has won the position, and Mr. Peck reiterated that this is for the rep that we will send to District 10. Mr. Hausermann called for nominations for the District

10 Representative and Alternate. Mr. Hausermann nominated Mr. Peck for Representative and Mr. Freeman for Alternate. Mr. Hausermann called for any other nominations. Ms. Hinnners seconded Mr. Hausermann's nominations. Mr. Hausermann closed nominations and called for a voice vote on the nomination of Mr. Peck for District 10 Representative and Mr. Freeman for alternate. All Aye with none opposed.

Mr. Hausermann stated that tonight's business was pretty much finished unless there was any other business. Ms. Hinnners asked if we also needed to put someone on the 911 board? Mr. Hausermann stated that it was not until later, but he guesses we could. Mr. Peck identified that position was currently held by Mr. Hausermann. Mr. Hausermann stated that it has been him recurrently. Mr. Freeman stated that currently the President of the CCTA does that, and Mr. Hausermann reiterated the same and that he doesn't have any problem with continuing. He stated that he went last year and there really wasn't anything there for us, but that it was really just an explanation of the 3 911 dispatchings that we have in the county, and that he was really just there as a courtesy representative of the Townships. Conversation continued with details of the 911 and taxes and monies distributions.

A member then asked a question about the detail of District 10 nomination, and what/how the townships need to proceed. Each Chairman and Fiscal Officer of the townships should have received the nominating forms, and needs to fill in the nominating form and then vote on and pass the nomination form and then send it in. The current deadline is Nov, 29th 2024. Mr. Freeman recommended that, even though township's meeting may be after the deadline to go ahead and fill the nomination form in, pass it, and send it in anyway as he has seen them extend the deadline sometimes 4 times. Mr. Freeman states that it is a likely scenario that they will extend the deadline. It would be considered late, but if they extend the deadline then it wouldn't matter if it's late.

Mr. Hausermann directed Mr. Baird to send a detailed letter to the townships alerting them to the District 10 nominating form and the importance of completing the nomination process, and specifically notifying them that the letter should be in the mailboxes for the chairman of the board of trustees and the fiscal officer and about the process for the nominations.

Mr. Hausermann again called for any more business that needs to be addressed. Mr. Freeman shared information about an email from Mr. Cooper pertaining to HB 296 that increases the amount of the townships' share in the Police/Fire benefits taking it from 19.4% up to about 23%, and by 2026-7 it increases further to 24%. Mr. Cooper's township has already come out against the bill, and encourages other townships to send letters to their representatives not to support this particular bill. Mr. Freeman shared that he found it interesting in the Fiscal Notes that Mr. Cooper sent along with information about the bill. Mr. Freeman had read through the Fiscal Notes and commented on the last line of the Fiscal Notes: "The bill has no direct fiscal effect on State agencies." The discussion and comments following stressed that the fiscal effect will certainly be felt by the townships.

Mr. Freeman asked if Mr. Baird had received the email, which he had not. Mr. Freeman will forward that email to Mr. Baird so he can share more detail about it to other townships. Ms. Hinnners commented further that she had read the bill which seemed to be only focused on Police, and she notes that this is just the Police fund. They've already done the Fire and it's going to be 28%! She stresses that there is a

big black hole that the townships are facing with regard to their Fire/EMS services, and multiple townships are heading that way ... and we don't need the State to be pushing us there.

Mr. Freeman shared an anecdote about a recent visit to Twin Bridge township, population 780. Very large place, but small population. They had a fire truck that was second hand that they got from a larger township, but it had a mechanical issue and went out of service. It was the only truck they had. In order to replace that fire-truck they have to come up with \$1.2M, and wait three years to receive it. So now they are stuck without a pumper. It's not that they were trying to be irresponsible, but simply that they don't have the type of resources that, for example, Pierce township or Goshen township or Union township has. As a local government, how do you deal with those issues ... and there is never an answer. Ms. Hinnners commented that the problem is a lot of townships, Wayne township included, operate very well but with grant money. So the townships are constantly competing with each other for that grant money to be able to cover the cost to equip their firefighters, and the trucks/equipment, etc. So, she feels that the way the State is handling that is wrong.

Mr. Hausermann continued on the subject by sharing an experience that Goshen township had with getting a new piece of equipment, and rather than selling the old equipment on .Gov they donated it to a township in northern Ohio for a value of \$1. The requirement that equipment must be rotated out in 20 years, regardless of the condition or if its ever even been used, they must replace it. He recommends that townships think about other smaller townships throughout the state that my not have funds to purchase or replace aging equipment and consider something like Goshen township has done in the past.

Mr. Freeman brought forward some information about another new committee that Clermont County is putting together than the CCTA needs to be thinking about that deals with housing, and the housing shortage and affordability issues. But we are facing a potential piece of legislation coming out of Columbus where they think they might like to take away townships zoning authority so that more houses can be built. Another part of that begins to talk about equipment and infrastructure and the more houses we put up the more people we have to serve. We don't want to say "no more houses/buildings/structures", but at the end of the day there are a lot of disincentives to townships to want to actually have to do that when that leads to challenges in staffing and equipment. And then when communities find out that there is a tool that could be theoretically used but, and not a lot of communities are doing it because the legislature makes it difficult to use which is a Residential TIF. So a community can get a RTIF which can be used to build roads/sewers and the like that can help a developer put together a subdivision, but the funds can't be used for sidewalks or fire-trucks or police cars, etc. So, nothing in that can be used for the township to be used to support the additional demand on the public services.

Mr. Hausermann asked if there was any other business for this evening. Mr. Baird stated that he still needed a motion to approve the October and November Treasurer's reports. Mr. Hausermann asked Mr. Baird to read through them real quick. Mr. Baird shared the details of the October report again, and quickly that there was no change to the funds for November. Mr. Peck made a motion to approve the

Treasurer's reports for October and November. Mr. Hausermann seconded. Mr. Hausermann called for a voice vote on the motion. Motion carried by majority, yea 13 nay 0.

Mr. Hausermann reminded there is a motion on the floor to adjourn, seconded by Mr. Peck. Meeting adjourned 8:13 PM with a Happy Thanksgiving wishes for all, and thanks to Williamsburg Township for the dinner.